

necessarily lack typographic style, color or graphics, since the main focus points at this stage are functionality, behavior and priority of content.

Prototyping

A ‘prototype’ is a simulation of the final interaction between the user and the interface. It might not look exactly like the final product, but will be vastly similar.

Why do you need prototypes?

Disruption occurs when you encounter an idea that is outside of your comfort zone. We have patterns of thinking that make us perceive the world in certain fixed ways and our mental frame of reference highlights some things and deletes other things from our awareness. Habits, frames of reference and comfort zones are very familiar blocks to creative thinking. When others, say, from a different industry, display new ways of thinking, and you think, “Hey, that’s really cool!”, it provides a disruption and breaks open a new way of thinking. However, don’t mistake thinking for innovation. You don’t innovate through powerpoints, you innovate by building prototypes of the product of service you intend to take to the masses.

Prototyping has several values. First of all, it makes your thinking tangible, so you can see what you think, you can see what your solution could be. Secondly, it provides other people with a chance to see what you’re thinking and lets them contribute to it, even if it’s a digital model. Thirdly, prototypes not only reveal what you know, but also what you don’t know. They provide insight into the problem that you’re trying to solve and the feasibility of the solution you’re trying to apply. This provides deep engagement in the project to bring out the best of your creativity.

Prototyping can be done via two means:

1. Paper prototyping: As the name suggests, this method involves prototyping on a paper-based wireframe itself that has no digital interface. It involves creating rough, even hand-sketched drawings of an interface to use as prototypes, or models, of a design. While paper prototyping seems simple, this method of usability testing can provide a great deal of useful feedback, which will result in the design of better products.

2. Rapid prototyping: This is the formation of a scalable model of the